

Ardmore to review use of Flock cameras

Kendall Timms, KTEN News

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ARDMORE, Okla. (KTEN) — After Ardmore city commissioners voted last month to renew the city's Flock camera contract, they're now considering changing course — putting the future of this law enforcement technology in the hands of voters.

The cameras — which read and process license plates and other information — are viewed by some as [intrusions on civil liberties](#).

"There's a lot of people saying they want their voices to be heard," said acting City Manager Shawn Geurin. "Well, what better way to let people have their voices being heard than go to the polls?"

That option will be up for consideration at the City Commission meeting on September 21. Should the decision to keep Flock cameras in Ardmore go to a vote of the people?

"Obviously, I was a little surprised with their decision to bring this back to the council meeting," said Commissioner At-Large Buddy Simon.

The idea for a vote comes from Mayor David Plesher.

"Rather than allow social media to determine this issue, I believe the citizens of Ardmore should have the final say," Plesher said in a written statement.

But Simon says the commissioners have already voted twice to keep the cameras around.

"I don't understand why the mayor decided to do a complete 360 turnaround," Simon said.

"This discussion actually started before the recall was ever posted," Geurin noted.

That recall — which has cleared phase one of necessary signatures — seeks to remove Simon's four fellow commissioners after he said his voice and input from the public was shut down during the Flock vote.

The city clerk confirmed all four commissioners responded to the petition.

Their responses will be included on the next petition phase, which needs 1,070 signatures within 30 days to trigger a special election.

"Tomorrow, the new petition will be readied for signatures, and it is going to move forward," Simon pledged.

Geurin reminds voters that there will be no public comment allowed at next Monday's meeting to discuss the Flock cameras contract.

"If they want their voices to be heard beforehand, they need to reach out to their council member and let them know how they feel," Geurin said.

While the city says considering a public vote on Flock has nothing to do with the recall drive, Simon believes the petitions will still get plenty of signatures.

"Flock is right now the hot point, but I think that they're just tired," Simon said. "Enough is enough for the citizens."

Earlier this month, [Carter County Sheriff DJ Long said he has opted out](#) of using the technology in his jurisdiction. [Thackerville](#) and [Marietta](#) recently decided to end relationships with Flock.

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